User Group A:

An agoraphobe can best be defined as a person with an extreme or irrational fear of entering open or crowded places, of leaving their own home, or of being in places from which escape is difficult. In a recent study by The National Institute of Mental Health, data was found to show that roughly 1% of the adult U.S. population struggles with this fear on a daily basis. In order to get a better understanding of this group, I conducted interviews with real patients of the disease, sourcing for pain points and daily struggles.

By far the most prevalent issue that was mentioned was the recurring rescheduling of important events, primarily doctor's appointments. Agoraphobes struggle to step outside the house unless they feel 100% safe in that decision, leading to a lot of last minute or in-the-moment rescheduling.

Additionally, doctor's offices/pharmacies were listed multiple times as dedicated "safe spaces" for patients, more than likely due to the presence of medical professionals. In order to make situations like this more desirable for the user group, I need to accommodate for this drawback of setting and spatial awareness. I plan to take both of these problems into consideration and create a neatly designed solution for my final project.

User Group B:

Alternatively, I could tackle the issue of the elderly on online banking apps. People past a certain age already have trouble navigating a smartphone screen on a daily basis. Combine that with tiny buttons and their life savings, and there's an issue that needs to be solved.

To be more specific, people above the age of 65 have a hard time reading and processing words on a small screen, especially one they already struggle operating. A bolder or enlarged text option occasionally helps with this issue, but small buttons and unified or low contrast color palettes can set them back too.

Furthermore, the lack of anti-scam measures in banking apps leads to a lot of elderly people being scammed out of their money, with Americans aged 60 and older losing over 3.4 billion to fraud in 2023, an 14% increase in complaints from the previous year according to the 2023 FBI IC3 Report.

Timeline:

- 4/13 - Schedule
- 4/15 - Personas
- 4/18 - Empathy Maps
- 4/20 - Journey Map/Pain Points/Barriers
- 4/22 - Wireframes
- 4/25 - Information Architecture
- 4/27 - Mid-Fidelity Renders
- 4/29 - 2nd Round of Mid- Fidelity Renders
- 5/06 - FINAL DUE DATE